

Delaware County Council Meeting - October 28th, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G2jugqhdss4
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: October 28, 2025

Presiding Officer: Council President Whitehead

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Whitehead called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. on October 28, 2025 (00:18:09).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Bookout, Mr. Planken (also referred to as Flanken/Blanken), Mr. Hughes, Mr. Chance (Can/Pants), Ms. Piper (Spiper), Mr. Goebel (Mogul/Mo), and Mr. Whitehead (Strawhead). (Note: Transcript attendance roll call includes Mr. Bookout, Mr. Planken, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Chance, Mr. Fifer, Mr. Freeman, and Mr. Whitehead).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mike (00:18:16).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was properly posted and approved via roll call vote (00:18:55).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **September 4, 2005 Special Meeting Minutes:** Approved via roll call vote (00:19:26).
 - **September 23, 2025 Council Meeting Minutes:** Tabled for further review due to issues identified by the Council (00:19:47).
 - **September 23, 2025 Final Budget Hearing Minutes:** Approved via roll call vote (00:20:36).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Financial Transfers

- **00:20:59 Circuit Court & Elections Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Moved funds to cover compensatory time from the last election that ran past the end-of-year budget. The line will remain empty until funding is corrected.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:22:45).
- **00:23:00 EMS Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Megan / Whitney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocated funds across part-time and paramedic lines to cover overtime (\$78,500 positive transfer for a net-zero total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:24:11).
- **00:24:31 Public Defender Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Whitney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed budget miscalculations from the previous year regarding PERF and health insurance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:26:02).
- **00:26:18 Communications / 911 Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Fred explained recurring annual adjustments for overtime and holiday pay, alongside adding redundant connectivity to the radio system (cost-shared with commissioners).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:28:05).
- **00:28:25 Sheriff Department Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed excess funds from deputies on injury leave/disability and military leave, reallocating funds to overtime and holiday pay to

- finish the year. Council members debated the systemic reliance on overtime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:32:00).
- **00:32:18 Jail & LIT Jail Transfers:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred vacant staff line funds to cover correctional officer overtime, addressing potential winter weather risks and hospital inmate guard requirements.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:34:07 and 00:35:09).
- **00:35:24 Highway / Bridge Engineer Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie D. (County Highway)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Moved remaining funds from a vacant project director salary line to pay the newly hired engineer. Noted that a \$40,000 state reimbursement has been successfully secured and received.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:36:34).
- **00:36:46 Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie / Whitney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocated \$30,000 from truck driver salary lines to overtime for the remainder of the year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:37:07).
- **00:37:22 Del. Co. Fair and Expo Transfer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Whitney / Donna
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred funds for winter diesel, gasoline, and operating supplies. Discussed fair attendance and upcoming contract adjustments.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:38:42).
- **00:38:52 Community Corrections (DCCC) DOC Grant & Project Income Transfers:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocated unspent grant funds from vacant positions into PERF to fully exhaust the state grant before year-end, avoiding returned funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:42:06).

Additional Appropriations

- **00:42:21 Commissioners Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested major additional appropriations totaling \$364,025.91, including significant increases for electric utilities (\$200,000), sewage (\$65,000), workers' comp claims, and equipment rental leases. Commissioner Brand outlined ongoing utility efficiency fixes (e.g., shutting off unneeded power factor capacitors) and safety stand-downs. Council expressed frustration regarding late notice and budgeting accuracy.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:03:37). *(Note: Votes recorded against/no included opposing voices).*
- **00:44:07 GIS Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Josh (for Kyle)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered a pay rate discrepancy caused by a 26 vs. 27 pay period calculation. The employee will repay the difference.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:04:57).
- **01:05:14 County Extension Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Whitney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed a payroll information (PI) form error for a first deputy. Wages are being garnished to correct the overpayment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:06:22).
- **01:06:38 Inheritance Tax to Rainy Day Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Whitney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$6,258.94.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:07:02).
- **01:07:19 Del. Co. Fair and Expo Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriated \$26,500 for electric (\$10,000), water (\$2,000), sewage (\$4,500), and equipment (\$10,000 - including exit doors with breaker bars and stolen tool replacements). Discussed raising low winter storage and rental rates to match fair market value.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:11:00).
- **01:12:07 CHIRP Grant Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy / Captain Johnson
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriated \$124,200 for the Comprehensive Highway Injury Reduction Program (CHIRP) reimbursable state grant supporting targeted patrols.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:13:05).
- **01:13:21 Public Defender Supplemental Fund Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriated \$37,490 from the supplemental fund to cover county general health insurance shortfalls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (01:14:59).

Ordinances & Resolutions

- **01:16:04 Ordinance 2025-25 (Salary Ordinance - First Reading):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Council
 - **Deliberation Summary:**

- *Section 9 (Part-Time Pay Ranges)*: Modernizes part-time job classifications by establishing a broad \$12<U+2013>\$20 hourly range to accommodate existing unlisted pay rates discovered during audits.
 - *Section 7 (Vacancy & Hiring Review Process)*: Discussed proposed language requiring department heads to notify the finance/council prior to posting vacancies to manage 2026/2027 fiscal pressures. Elected officials (including Clerk Rick Spangler and Sheriff Tony Skinner) raised concerns over potential delays and urged a meeting of all elected officials to review policies collaboratively. Public safety exemptions were discussed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition**: Approved for first reading by roll call vote (01:40:20).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period (02:12:26, 02:12:37).*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **IT / Google Workspace Trial**: Update provided on the trial ending soon, encouraging feedback on workflows (01:45:28).
 - **2026 Meeting Schedule**: Approved by roll call vote (01:47:57).
 - **24-Pay Period Discussion**: Council and auditor discussed exploring a transition from 26/27 pay periods to a standardized 24-pay period system to reduce payroll processing errors.
 - **Cost-Savings Initiatives**: Commissioners highlighted upcoming reviews of liability insurance carriers, desk phone elimination (targeting 130+ inactive lines), and office supply/filter contracts.
 - **Elected Officials Reports**:
 - Sheriff Tony Skinner requested exploring monthly (instead of quarterly) pension payments and supported the 24-pay transition.
 - Coroner Gavin Green reported 578 cases year-to-date (projecting ~694 for 2025), highlighting administrative bottlenecks caused by outside hospital liability reviews for natural deaths involving prior minor injuries.
 - Councilman Hughes commented on local media coverage regarding Senate Bill 1 and property tax revenue projections vs. actual tax cap losses.
 - **Upcoming Public Hearing**: Scheduled for November 18, 2025, at 9:00 a.m. regarding the building lease for the addiction recovery and rehabilitation center (01:26:40).

- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Jessica, seconded by Dan, and passed by roll call vote (01:17:39).

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